

2026 KUMC Microbiome Symposium

Please complete the survey below.

Thank you!

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Presurvey Questions Draft

Analysis Workshop

Per feedback from the 2025 University of Kansas Medical Center Microbiome Symposium, we are inviting attendees to complete a brief survey (five questions, approximately five minutes) to help us understand the current landscape of microbiome data analysis within attendees of this symposium.

These responses will directly inform the microbiome data analysis workshop for the 2026 Microbiome Symposium to ensure the content is aligned with attendees' experience levels and needs.

Thank you for taking the time to provide your input.

1. What best describes your primary role?

- ☐ Wet-lab researcher
- ☐ Clinician
- ☐ Bioinformatician / computational biologist
- ☐ Statistician
- ☐ Student / trainee
- ☐ Other _____

Goal: Understand the general makeup of the audience. Tailor the level of different sections based on the proportion of those within each category.

2. Which microbiome data types do you work with?
(Select all that apply)

- ☐ Targeted sequencing (16S, ITS)
- ☐ Shotgun metagenomics
- ☐ Metatranscriptomics
- ☐ Metabolomics
- ☐ I don't currently work with microbiome data
- ☐ Other _____

Goal: Identify the current microbiome data types being used in this audience.

3. What aspect of microbiome analyses do you find most confusing or want clarified? (Select all that apply)

- ☐ When to use each diversity metric and what they mean
- ☐ Understanding the statistics (p-values, multiple testing correction, compositionality)
- ☐ The overall workflow of the analysis from raw data to biological interpretation
- ☐ Quality control decisions and their impact on down-stream analysis and results
- ☐ How to interpret microbiome analysis results

Goal: Find the "pinch point" in this group when attempting to analyze microbiome data.

4. What is your main goal for attending this session?

- ☐ Learn how to critically evaluate microbiome analyses in papers
- ☐ Better communicate with bioinformaticians and collaborators about analysis choices
- ☐ Gain a conceptual understanding of what happens at each pipeline step
- ☐ Interpret analysis results and figures more confidently
- ☐ Learn how to analyze microbiome data myself

Goal: Get a clear understanding of the bottom-line for participants to have a clear goal for the workshop.

(Optional) 5. Please leave any other comments about the workshop below.
